Mile Marker #9: Think It Through

The thinking behind the thinking, and your first STAR(T) draft.

In this module you learned to spot thinking traps and use the 4C Check to slow down before reacting. You also saw how that same thinking makes a STAR(T) story more honest and specific.

This Mile Marker has two parts: a look at your own thinking patterns, and your first STAR(T) draft, a real starting point for your capstone.

Two ways to use this handout. It matches the Mile Marker #9 assignment in Blackboard. Print it and fill it in by hand, or type in the boxes below and save a PDF. Either way, upload the photo, scan, or PDF to the assignment. You can also type your answers in Blackboard instead.

NAME _____ **DATE** _____

Part I: Know your pattern

QUESTION 1

Name Your Pattern and a Better Question

Which thinking trap or bias from this module feels most like you? Choose from jumping to conclusions, all-or-nothing thinking, overgeneralizing, mind reading, catastrophizing, confirmation bias, familiarity bias, the halo effect, or negativity bias, or describe one in your own words.

***A strong answer** names one pattern, gives a real example, offers a better question, and names one strategy for slowing down.*

The pattern that feels most like me

A real example of when it showed up

A better question to ask myself next time

One strategy that helps me slow down

Part II: Your first STAR(T) draft

QUESTION 2

Tell Your Story

Pick one real experience, from this semester or the recent past, and write it out using all five STAR(T) steps.

***A strong answer** includes all five steps, uses "I" in the Action, and sounds like you.*

Situation: What was going on?

Task: What needed to happen, and what was your role?

Action: What did you specifically do? Not the group. You.

Result: What happened?

Transfer: Why does this matter going forward, for your next class, a future job, or your life?

QUESTION 3

Check It with the 4Cs

Reread your draft using the 4C Check and answer honestly. Then revise at least one part of your draft, and say what you changed.

***A strong answer** answers honestly, and shows a real revision to at least one step.*

Clarity and Context: is my Situation clear?

Credibility: is my Action and Result accurate, or did I round up?

Consequences: is my Transfer specific, or could it apply to anyone?

What I revised, and why

QUESTION 4

Name the Skill

Which of the 10 Essential Skills does this story connect to? You'll confirm your four capstone skills later, so for now, take your best guess and say why.

***A strong answer** names one skill and connects it to something specific in your story.*